Revision Date:
09/1/2018

Background:
Effective 1/1/2014, Assembly Bill (AB) 74 modified the WTW sequence to allow individuals who are identified during Appraisal as being in need of Mental Health/Substance Abuse and/or Family Stabilization Services to be engaged in WTW through these barrier removal activities.

Purpose:
The purpose of this revision is to include AB 74 changes and streamline policies and procedures related to initial engagement activities.

Policy:
Newly referred WTW participants, whose CalWORKs has been approved for the first time or after a break in aid longer than 30 days, are required to participate in Initial Job Search (JS) after Appraisal, unless they meet specific exclusion criteria or are identified as being better served by other initial engagement activities such as Family Stabilization (CPG 10-007.A), Mental Health/Substance Abuse Services (MHS/SAS) and/or Domestic Violence Services (CPG 40-100.O). Initial engagement activities may be assigned in sequence or concurrently prior to the signing of the first WTW plan.

Initial Job Search
Initial JS activities include looking for suitable job openings through independent and/or supervised Job Search, contacting potential employers, completing applications, submitting resumes, interviewing for jobs and networking. Job Clubs may be used to develop job seeking strategies and inform participants of employer's expectations and employee's responsibilities.

Initial JS is a core activity that cannot exceed federal limits (up to a total of 6 weeks or up to a total of 12 weeks in a 12-month period when the State of California is considered a "Needy State"). Initial JS is assigned for up to 4 consecutive weeks. Extension(s) beyond the initial 4 weeks may only be approved, one week a time, if needed to complete scheduled job interviews and/or accept employment offer(s) resulting from participation in the previous weeks. If after the 4 consecutive weeks there are no pending interviews or job offers requiring a follow-up, JS extension will not be granted and an Assessment will be completed to assign appropriate activities in a WTW plan.

The length of Initial Job Search may be shortened when:
- Identified barrier(s) are precluding participation and satisfactory progress in assigned activity
- The participant would benefit from education or training in place of Initial Job Search activities

Initial Job Search Exclusions
The following are allowable exclusions from Initial Job Search:
- Participant has barriers that must be addressed with different initial engagement activities
- Participant is meeting participation requirements with employment or self-employment
- JS activity conflicts with employment or participation in SIP or other approved educational/training activity

- Participant is a 19-year old parenting teen with no high school diploma or equivalent certificate, who is ineligible to participate in Cal-Learn
- Participant is a noncitizen victim of human trafficking, domestic violence or other serious crimes who is not yet authorized to work in the United States (CPG 10-200.A)

Mental Health and Substance Abuse Assessment

A participant may be referred to MHS and/or SAS as an initial engagement core activities for up to 4 weeks if there is a concern that a mental health and/or substance abuse problem exists that will impair his/her ability to obtain/retain employment, or participate in other WTW activities. An assessment and development of a WTW plan are required to extend these activities beyond the four-week period.

WTW Plan and Treatment Services

WTW Plans will be developed based on the results of the mental health and/or substance abuse assessment, and will include appropriate accommodations or restrictions, supportive services, and treatment requirements to meet the participants' needs. Substance Abuse Services may include:

- Assessment/Evaluation
- Case management
- Treatment and/or Counseling
- Monitoring of attendance and satisfactory progress
- Referral to or provision of other appropriate services

10-005.E.5 Substance Abuse Treatment and Concurrent Activities

Concurrent participation in another WTW activity is required if the participant is in a substance abuse treatment program for longer than six months. WTW participation requirements are considered to be met and concurrent activities are not required if the participant is either:

- In a state-licensed residential facility or a certified nonresidential substance abuse program that requires him/her to stay at the program site for at least three hours a day, three days per week, or
- Unable to participate in other WTW activities as determined by the treatment provider

Procedure:

Processing Guide 10-005.E.1

References:

All County Letter (ACL) 15-09, Eligibility Assistance Standards (EAS) 42.711.53, CalWORKs Program Guide (CPG) 10-005.H.

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 09/30/2021.

Approval for Release:

9-17-18

Rick Wanne, Director
Eligibility Operations